Answers and talk notes

Represent and Describe Data in a Histogram

What your student is learning

Tonight we read a histogram we already know how to build, and say in words what its shape tells us about the data.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **A.** The peak. The tallest bar is called the peak. So the answer is: The peak.
2. **C.** 10–19. The tallest bar has height 5, and it sits over 10–19.
3. **B.** Symmetric. When the two sides of the peak match, the data is symmetric. So the answer is: Symmetric.
4. **D.** Skewed to the right. The long tail points right, so the data is skewed to the right. So the answer is: Skewed to the right.
5. **A.** 20–29. The peak is over 20–29, so most values are there and a typical value is in 20–29.
6. **C.** 10. Add the heights: 1 + 4 + 3 + 2 = 10 values.

Talk about it

Where is the peak, and which side, if any, has a long tail?

Home mission

Stack coins in three columns on the table: 2, 4 and 2. Ask your student if the two sides match. Now add a fourth column with 1 coin. Which way does the tail stretch now?

When they are stuck, ask

- Which bar is tallest, and what interval does it cover?
- Does the left side of the peak look like the right side?
- Which direction does the long tail point?

Try not to say

- A tall bar in the middle always means symmetric.
- Skewed right means the tall bars are on the right.
- Leave a space between the bars so it looks neater.